

Chapter 25-5

Around them were set up more than a dozen machines, with dozens of staff members on scene. When filming close-ups, the actors themselves kissed toward the camera, so this kind of scene didn't create too strong a stimulus for her.

The film's pace quickened at this moment. After the kiss came the bedroom scene with the lights dimmed.

This director's control over this type of shot was too strong, making Liang Shi once suspect that this person had started out making adult films. Before this bedroom scene, she specifically searched for information and found that wasn't the case.

This person started out making serious documentaries, specifically about cultural relics and such. Halfway through, they suddenly switched and decided to make movies. This was their first film after changing tracks.

It had to be said, this director had something special about them.

They filmed a bedroom scene that was both pure and sensual.

Close-ups of fingers unbuttoning clothes, hearts beating rapidly and intensely from nervousness, breathing that couldn't be calmed - all focused on the second and third buttons of the shirt.

The female lead's fingers were slender, but appeared clumsy when unbuttoning, drawing out the audience's anticipation.

The other female lead, because her movements were too slow and she couldn't wait, reached over to help her.

The moment their fingers touched, it triggered a new round of kissing.

Then came close-ups of the lighting, pulling from near to far, but the sound from the speakers didn't diminish.

Such sounds were usually dubbed by professional voice actors, with high compatibility to the actors' own voices.

At such moments, having no visuals was better than having visuals.

After cutting the scene came character close-ups - one quilt wrapped around two people, a very passionate bed scene.

Just as Liang Shi was hesitating whether to skip this scene, her finger not yet touching the screen, a weak voice came from beside her: "Water.."

Xu Qingzhu was half-awake, her throat so dry and hoarse she could barely speak. Even using all her strength to say one word felt like her throat had been scraped with sand, painfully so.

She frowned, her body's discomfort not yet completely relieved.

Hearing this, Liang Shi immediately put down her phone and got up to get her a water cup.

Then she walked to her side, supporting her back to help her drink.

She was like a traveler walking in the desert, extremely parched. Her hot palm lightly brushed across Liang Shi's hand holding the water cup.

She gulped down an entire cup, with water stains still remaining at the corners of her mouth.

Those lips, moistened by water, glistened like ripples.

It easily brought to mind the surface of the sea with ripples, as if thousands of acres of sunset were scattered upon it, lustrous and radiant.

Even half-awake, she politely said thank you.

Liang Shi originally thought she would wipe away the water stains at the corners of her mouth before sleeping again, but clearly, she had no such awareness at the moment. After drinking the water, she lay back down on the bed, but her palm still rested on the back of Liang Shi's hand, pulling her down with the momentum.

Liang Shi's heart seemed to have fallen somewhere unknown, her thoughts somewhat drifting, and she was effortlessly pulled down by her.

When Liang Shi realized what was happening, her ear was only millimeters away from Xu Qingzhu, as if those lips glistening with water stains would touch her ear in the next second.

Her ear could feel the warm moisture, like sea breeze gently caressing.

The warm yellow light stretched this enchantment to its extreme.

Like a trap made of light - one careless step and you would fall in.

And when falling into the light, you would quickly be enveloped by tender desire.

But Liang Shi quickly sat up straight. She took a deep breath.

She freed her hand from Xu Qingzhu's grasp and fanned her burning cheeks with her hand.

She had been so content with solitude for so many years, how had she become so flustered by temptation just a few days after coming here?

Like desire that had been dormant for a long time feeling the spring air and eagerly wanting to break through the soil.

Yet she forcibly suppressed it.

Liang Shi placed the water cup to one side and glanced at Xu Qingzhu, who had fallen asleep again.

The water stains at the corners of her mouth still glistened. Having OCD about such things, Liang Shi raised her hand to wipe them away.

Her thumb touched those bright red lips, and the sensation of skin against skin became real in an instant. Even though she tried her best to suppress her desires, physiological things were hard to forcefully suppress. Liang Shi turned to look at her sideways.

After a long while, she turned her face away and covered it with her hands.

Her ears were already starting to burn.

Liang Shi got up and went to the bathroom to take a shower.

It was... quite hard to endure.

After showering, she came out with coolness all over her body. After dismissing all those random thoughts from her mind, she became somewhat more clear-headed.

She returned to the bedside again, deliberately pushing that bundle of quilt toward Xu Qingzhu's side. She occupied a small space and continued watching the movie.

On her phone screen were two bodies entwined. In this book's world, film and television requirements regarding sexual content weren't censored too severely. As it turned out, audiences loved watching it too, especially well-made ones that would have extremely high box office returns.

So this movie had quite a few sexual scenes.

The segment she had seen before used empty shots¹ - that is, when it was time to dim the lights, they directly switched to night scenes of the city.

This was also a common technique directors used when filming such scenes.

But this time it wasn't like that. Instead, they explicitly filmed this scene.

They were in a dim room, on one bed, with fingers falling on each other's softness.

They gazed at each other, looking deeply into each other's eyes...

"So hot..." came Xu Qingzhu's somewhat suppressed voice.

Even more enchanting than the voices of the characters in the movie at their most passionate moments.

Liang Shi immediately pulled the quilt toward herself a bit, and Xu Qingzhu half-opened her eyes, just in time to see the scene on the screen.

That was probably the most passionate segment of the movie.

The two female leads became one in that moment, reaching directly into each other's souls.

The sound of water arose everywhere.

The entire room echoed with the voices of the two, gently calling each other's names.

The names were spoken against the tip of the tongue, and they were close enough that they only needed to use whispered breath to hear clearly.

Liang Shi: "..."

She immediately turned her phone face down.

But the sound continued, accompanied by the enchanting background music.

Anyone would think impure thoughts.

"I didn't..." Liang Shi instinctively wanted to explain, but Xu Qingzhu smiled instead. Her voice, not yet fully awake, was even more alluring than what was in the movie as she asked: "Was it good?"

Liang Shi: "...Not bad."

She had never been good at lying.

And her brain had a momentary short-circuit, so she just went along with her words.

She heard Xu Qingzhu say: "Finish watching and sleep early."

Liang Shi: "...?"

That's it?

Liang Shi thought she had woken up and wanted to ask where the blankets were, but before she could speak, she saw her turn over and start breathing evenly again.

"?"

What a false alarm.

But this was also quite embarrassing for Liang Shi.

Her previous image had always been that of a serious veteran cadre with a Buddhist² demeanor. Watching adult films didn't quite fit her image.

Although she had... watched them before.

This was a very normal physiological need.

But being discovered was another story entirely.

So she immediately put away her phone.

Liang Shi lay there thinking: How to get through this long night?

Her body was only touching the edge of the bed. Although this bed was large enough, she was still afraid that Xu Qingzhu might sleep restlessly and like to roll around in bed, so she left plenty of space for her.

She was usually someone who slept very peacefully. Wherever she was positioned before sleeping, she would still be in the same place when she woke up.

Her thoughts were still in chaos, but she still couldn't resist her body's natural sleepiness.

Before she could figure out what to eat for breakfast tomorrow, she had already fallen asleep.

Footnotes:

¹ Empty shots (空镜) - Cinematographic technique where the camera focuses on scenery or objects without characters, often used to transition between scenes or imply action without showing it directly.

² Buddhist (佛系) - Modern Chinese slang meaning having a calm, peaceful, non-competitive attitude toward life, like a Buddhist monk's detached approach to worldly matters.